

RICSE- Master Thesis Guide

1. The Master Thesis

The Master Thesis (MT) is an autonomous and individual work that gives the student the opportunity to focus on some of the topics dealt with in the academic subjects of the Master, as well as, to integrate all together the capacities and competences achieved along the Master's degree.

The MT must show that the student can carry out sound and rigorous academic research and/or innovation. It should present an original work that is carefully developed, validated and documented, and it should be done for oneself with the guide of an advisor. The MT does not imply a practice internship nor the collaboration of the student in a research group or a research department. However, the work can be related to the project developed by the student during the Work Placement Subject.

The MT document **must not exceed 15,000 words**, excluding appendices and bibliography. It must be written in English. To evaluate the MT, the student has to deliver the document of the work and expound orally the results to the Master Thesis Committee **(if signed with digital certificates, a single digital copy of the document is required; otherwise, three printed copies of the document should be delivered to the coordinator).**

2. Management of the subject

The responsible persons for the Master Thesis Subject are:

- The Coordinator of the Subject
- The Academic Tutors
- The Master Thesis Committee (consist of 3 PhD members)

A. Coordinator of the Subject

The coordinator of the MT subject appoints an academic tutor from the UAB to each student of the master, depending on the topic of his/her work.

The coordinator must guarantee the correct functioning of the module. Whenever any question appears to students and/or academic tutors during the development of the MT, they can request a meeting with the coordinator of the module for advice or help.

B. Academic Tutor

The MT dissertation must be written under the guidance of an advisor. The advisor has to be a PhD researcher from a department or a research institute that cooperates with the UAB. The academic tutor¹ will supervise the student follow-up, providing general guidance, and helping the student to refine the objective of the work and to develop the argument of the thesis. Once the student has met the

¹ *When the student performs the Work Placement internship in the UAB and the MT is related to this research, the follow-up is supervised by the research tutor, not the academic tutor.*

academic tutor, they will consider the best date for the presentation of the dissertation and will agree on a timetable for meetings and submission of drafts.

It is the responsibility of the student to keep the tutor informed of his/her progress!

C. Master's Thesis Committee

There will be a Master's Thesis Committee for each student, consisting of 3 PhD members responsible for the evaluation of the thesis. These members usually are:

- A coordinator
- The academic tutor of the thesis
- One professor of the master (who will be appointed by the subject coordinator)

3. Schedule

The Master Thesis subject (12 ECTS) is scheduled on the second term of the course and involves 300 hours of student work.

The student will agree with the academic tutor on the hours to be devoted to writing up the work and determine the date on which the thesis will be submitted.

The student can deliver the MT any time along the year, but two deadlines are set depending on the time when the thesis defense will take place.

MT Defense Calls	Defense dates	MT submission deadline
1 st Call	July 13-17, 2026	July 3th, 2026
2 nd Call	September 14-18, 2026	September 4th, 2026

A digital version in PDF of the MT document must be uploaded to the corresponding Moodle section before the submission date indicated above. If the PDF document has not been digitally signed, three printed copies of the MT document must be also delivered to the Master's Coordinator, who will deliver a printed copy of the work to the rest of the committee members.

Mentoring

During the MT subject, the student has the right to up to 10 hours of tutoring with the academic tutor (or the person that supervises the follow-up). However, a minimum of tutorial meetings is advised, following the schedule below:

First "get-in-touch" meeting.

(~January): initial contact with the academic tutor and discussion of potential topics for the work. The main goal of a MT is to answer a specific scientific question.

Initial meeting

(~February/March): MT scheme approval including tentative research questions to be answered and bibliography.

Discussion of the sources and the existing preliminary information on the topic of the thesis and the main question(s) to be addressed.

A proposal of the objective(s) of the MT and the extent to which the question/problem proposed will be developed.

General explanation of the methodology that will be used to achieve the objectives.

Identification of the necessary steps to develop the work, setting a realistic schedule to carry it out.

Bibliography, references and complementary sources consulted.

Progression meetings:

(April-May): supervision of the MT development.

Assessment of the chronogram with regards to the MT landmarks. Any changes done or planned to be incorporated in the short term must be indicated and justified to the academic tutor.

If necessary, identify and justify any changes in the objective and methodology of work planned.

Bibliography, references and complementary sources consulted.

Final meeting

(June- July): discussion of MT drafts and delivery of the final version to the academic tutor.

Assessment of the chronogram with regards to the MT milestones. Any changes done or planned to be incorporated in the short term must be indicated and justified.

General explanation of the methodology that has been followed, highlighting any changes done with respect to the initial proposal.

Information on the sources consulted.

Format and presentation of the results.

Discussion of the results and conclusions.

6. Presentation format of the Master Thesis

Within a common design, the MT can be developed according to different typologies. The thesis outline can be adapted to each specific work but, as an example, the following sections would be common:

Cover page
Supervisor (and Tutor) signatures
Acknowledgements
Table of contents
List of figures / List of tables
Abstract
Introduction and State of the Art
Objectives
Methodology and Development
Results and Discussion
Conclusions
Bibliography

Note: The items previously cited are to be considered as a guide for the thesis organization. The student and the academic tutor can exclude or include other items and customize the work, as needed.

The aspects that must be taken in consideration are:

- The work must be written in English. It is recommended that the maximum extension of the work do not exceed 15,000 words (excluding Bibliography and Appendices).
- The formal criteria (good presentation, orthography, grammar, use the standards rules when citing references) must be complied for the work to be evaluated.
- The cover page should use the template included at the end of this guide (a Ms-Word file is available at the moodle, as well). It should include:
 - Student's name and surname
 - Master's degree title
 - Submission date
 - Name of the academic tutor (or the person that follows up on the project) and the department or institution associated.

The MT must be approved and signed (in the second page) by the academic tutor of the UAB (or the person that follows up on the project).

When the MT has been developed during the work placement internship in an external institution, the student may also include the name of the tutor in practice in the cover page. Digital signatures of the institution supervisor should be at the second page of the document (see sample template at the end of the guide).

The student must always work under the good practices and behavior codes for research and professional practices. Every time that the student expresses a relevant idea that is not his/hers, the student must cite the reference of its source, allowing the reader to contrast the information. If the Master's Thesis Committee detects PLAGIARISM, the MT will be immediately voided.

Please, read page in next link to know what is considered plagiarism:
<http://www.plagiarism.org>

7. The Master Thesis defense

The Thesis defense will include:

- **Students turn:** the student exposes its work for 20 minutes approx.
- **Questions turn:** The three committee members ask during approx. 15 minutes to evaluate the exposed thesis and ask questions to the defender.
- **Reply turn:** the student will have time enough to answer the questions formulated by the committee.

For the thesis defense the student has to prepare a presentation in a PowerPoint format or similar. It is advisable that the presentation won't exceed 20 slides.

8. Assessment

The MT is evaluated by the Master Thesis Committee, which consist of three PhD members, professors of the UAB. Two of these members usually are the Coordinator of the subject and the Academic Tutor of the defended thesis, so the MT Committee can differ from one student to another. The ultimate composition of the MT Committee will be announced in advance.

The final assessment will result of:

- The delivered MT document (50%)
- The oral exposition and defense of the MT (50%)

The following points will be taken in consideration in the evaluation:

- The time and effort devoted by the student to the development of the different parts of the work.
- The extent to which organizational standards, structure of the work and formal aspects detailed in this guide have been followed.
- The achievement of the skills and competences developed in the Master Thesis module, such as:
 1. Having and providing original knowledge in computer-based science or engineering for the development of new ideas within a research context.
 2. Applying and integrating the knowledge and abilities reached along the master to face new goals and unknown environments.
 3. Critical and reflection skills.
 4. Ability to propose innovative solutions to research problems in the field of study.
 5. The design, management and development of a research project, being capable of understanding and interpreting the results obtained and extracting conclusions.
 6. Clearly communicating the research conclusions.
 7. Having a current and future perspective of the scope of computer-based science or engineering.

9. Publication and confidentiality

The Master Thesis could be published in the UAB Digital Data Deposit (DDD). This tool collects, manages, preserves and disseminates scientific, academic and institutional production at the University. For more information about the DDD consult:

<https://ddd.uab.cat/>

The publication of the Master Thesis in the DDD is NOT COMPULSORY and requires the authorization of the author, the academic tutor and the external tutor, when the thesis has been based on the work placement internship.

The standard agreement for the Thesis publication on the DDD is available in the MT webpage.

UAB
**Universitat Autònoma
de Barcelona**

**Escola
d'Enginyeria**

MASTER THESIS

<TITLE>

<Author>

**MSc in Research and Innovation for Computer-based Science and
Engineering**

**Supervisor/s: <Name of Supervisor/s>
<Supervisor's Department / Institute>**

Cerdanyola del Vallès, <Date>

Aproved by:

Signature:

Supervisor: <Name and Department/Institution of supervisor>

Signature:

Academic Tutor: <Name and Department> (if supervisor does not belong to UAB)